

TSANGAI BUSINESS GROWTH SERIES · #08

# The 30-Day AI Roadmap

A week-by-week plan that takes you from "we should use AI" to one automation running and hours back on your calendar — in one month.

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## WHO IT'S FOR

Owners who keep saying "this is the month we figure out AI"

## TIME REQUIRED

15 min today · ~2 hrs/week for 4 weeks

## WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

One automation live, one habit built, and proof in hours saved by day 30

## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

# You don't need an AI strategy. You need an AI month.

Thirty days, four themes: build the habit, bank quick wins, automate one process, then measure and lock it in. Two hours a week. No new hires, no big spend.

*"We're looking into AI" is where good intentions go to die. The owners who win don't study longer — they pick a lane and run 30 days. This roadmap is that lane. Day 1 takes ten minutes, and it's today.*

— Ray, TsangAI Consulting

## WHY THIS MATTERS

### 30 days

Long enough to build a habit and ship one automation — short enough to stay urgent

### 2 hrs/wk

All this plan asks — less time than one long "should we use AI" meeting

### Day 30

You'll have a number: hours saved. Numbers keep momentum alive

## THE ONE IDEA

### Habit first. Wins second. Automation third. Proof last.

Most owners start with automation and stall — you can't automate a tool you don't use. This order works because each week stands on the one before it.

**Example:** A design agency owner followed this exact order. Week 1 felt too easy — just using AI daily. By week 3 she automated proposal first drafts. Day 30 tally: seven hours a week back, and a team that stopped rolling their eyes at AI.

## YOUR 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN (THIS IS DAY 1)

- ☐ Subscribe to ChatGPT or Claude (~\$20/mo) and pin it as your first browser tab
- ☐ Write your 3-sentence Business Brief (template on page 4)
- ☐ Use it on one real task from today's to-do list
- ☐ Put "AI hour" on your calendar, same time, twice a week for 4 weeks

## Four weeks, one focus each — plus day 30

### 1 Week 1 — Build the habit (days 1–7)

You and AI, daily. Every writing task gets a "prompt first" attempt: emails, quotes, replies, ideas. No automation yet — just reps.

**Do this:** Day 1 quick win above, then one real task through AI every workday. Save prompts that work.

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### 2 Week 2 — Bank quick wins (days 8–14)

Widen from you to your busiest workflows: meeting notes, review replies, follow-ups. Involve one team member so it's not just "the owner's thing."

**Do this:** Add an AI notetaker to your calls. Give one teammate your 3 best saved prompts.

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### 3 Week 3 — Automate ONE process (days 15–21)

Pick your most repeated, rules-based, hours-eating task (guide #03 finds it). Build the smallest version that works — a lead auto-reply, a follow-up sequence, an intake flow.

**Do this:** Block two 1-hour sessions. Ship the ugly version by day 21. Ugly and live beats perfect and planned.

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### 4 Week 4 — Measure and lock it in (days 22–29)

Count hours saved, note what broke, fix the automation's rough edges, and write a one-page SOP so it survives without you.

**Do this:** Fill in the Day-30 Scorecard on page 4. Fix the #1 annoyance in your automation.

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### 5 Day 30 — Decide what's next

With a real number in hand, choose: deepen this automation, start the next one, or bring in help to go faster. Momentum is the asset — don't park it.

**Do this:** Run your scorecard through the Review Prompt on page 4 and book next month's target.

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#### COMMON MISTAKES

### This is where most business owners get stuck.

They skip week 1 and jump to automation with no habits underneath. They pick a week-3 project too big to ship in seven days. And they never count the hours saved — so by month two, nobody remembers why they bothered.

#### PRO TIP

Tell your team on day 1: "For 30 days we're trying AI on the boring stuff. Nobody's job is changing — we're deleting the parts of your day you already hate." Resistance drops to zero when AI targets the work nobody wants.

# Your calendar, your scorecard, your review prompt

## The 30-Day Calendar (print this)

| WEEK | FOCUS                                       | SHIP BY END OF WEEK                               | DONE                     |
|------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1    | Build the habit — AI on one real task daily | Business Brief written · 5+ prompts saved         | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2    | Quick wins — notetaker + team member in     | Notetaker on all calls · 1 teammate using prompts | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 3    | Automate ONE process, smallest version      | Automation live (even if ugly)                    | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4    | Measure, fix, document                      | Day-30 Scorecard filled · 1-page SOP written      | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## The Business Brief (Day 1)

My business: [NAME], a [WHAT YOU DO] serving [WHO] in [AREA]. Our tone: [FRIENDLY / PROFESSIONAL / PLAIN]. Never use hype words or jargon.

## The Day-30 Scorecard

- ✓ Hours saved per week: \_\_\_\_\_
- ✓ Tasks now AI-first: \_\_\_\_\_
- ✓ Automations live: \_\_\_\_\_
- ✓ Team members using AI weekly: \_\_\_\_\_
- ✓ Best win in one sentence: \_\_\_\_\_

## The Day-30 Review Prompt

You are my AI operations coach. My business: [WHAT YOU DO]. My 30-day results: [HOURS] hours/week saved, automation built: [WHAT IT DOES], biggest struggle: [STRUGGLE]. Based on this: 1) what should my next 30-day target be, 2) what's the single highest-leverage next automation, 3) what should I stop doing manually immediately? Be specific and blunt.

### STUCK IN WEEK 3?

Shrink the project until it fits in one hour. "AI drafts the reply, I hit send" is a real automation. Version two can come next month.

## Turn this guide into one win this week.

A guide you read changes nothing. A page you fill in does. Two minutes — do it while it's fresh.

### 1 · WHERE I AM TODAY

My Day 1 date: \_\_\_\_\_ My week-3 automation candidate: \_\_\_\_\_

### 2 · THE ONE THING I'M FIXING THIS WEEK

My one fix: \_\_\_\_\_

The first small step (under 15 minutes): \_\_\_\_\_

Small beats big. Pick something you can finish in one sitting.

### 3 · WHEN I'M DOING IT

Day: \_\_\_\_\_ Time: \_\_\_\_\_ Booked in my calendar? ☐

Open your calendar and book it now — a plan without a time slot is a wish.

### 4 · AFTER — WHAT HAPPENED

My result (hours saved, jobs booked, thing shipped): \_\_\_\_\_

What I'll do differently next time: \_\_\_\_\_

### NOTES

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### KEEP THE STREAK

One fix a week is 52 upgrades a year. When this page is full, re-take the guide — a rising score is proof your systems are working.